

**SECTION 4      Questions 31–40**

Complete the notes below.

Write **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** for each answer.

## Mass Strandings of Whales and Dolphins

Mass strandings: situations where groups of whales, dolphins, etc. swim onto the beach and die

Common in areas where the **31** ..... can change quickly

Several other theories:

First

### Parasites

e.g. some parasites can affect marine animals' **32** ....., which they depend on for navigation

Another theory is related to ...

### Toxins

Poisons from **33** ..... or ..... are commonly consumed by whales  
originated from

e.g. Cape Cod (1988) – whales were killed by **saxitoxin**

Alternatively, ... (另外)

### Accidental Strandings

Animals may follow prey ashore, e.g. Thurston (1995)

However

Unlikely because the majority of animals were not **34** ..... when they stranded

There're also some ...

### Human Activity

**35** ..... from military tests are linked to some recent strandings

One of these, ...

The Bahamas (2000) stranding was unusual because the whales

For one,

• were all **36** .....

In addition,

• were not in a **37** .....

Test 1

A final theory, ...

**Group Behaviour**  
particularly

- More strandings in the most **38** ..... species of whales

is also supported by ...

- 1994 dolphin stranding – only the **39** ..... was ill

Without ... however it is very hard for us to do anything  
about this phenomenon except to ...

**Further Reading**

*Marine Mammals Ashore* (Connor) – gives information about stranding **40** .....